

CRAFT - Timeline Assist

Help Guide for Autodesk 3ds Max 2027

Purpose	Compact dark timeline helper for focusing frame ranges, managing animation sections, and saving timeline presets
Install	Drag CRAFT - Timeline Assist.mzp into 3ds Max and choose Install.
Launch	Use CRAFT > CRAFT - Timeline Assist, or assign a shortcut from Category: CRAFT.
Uninstall	Drag the MZP and choose Uninstall, or use CRAFT > Uninstall Timeline Assist.

Core Timeline Controls

- Drag the center of the main timeline bar to pan the focused frame range.
- Drag the left or right edge handle to resize the focused range.
- Use the mouse wheel over the timeline bar to zoom in or out.
- Double-click the timeline bar to reset focus back to the full range.
- Type values directly into the frame boxes to edit full range or focused range values.

Animation Presets

- Create a preset from the current focused range with the add preset button.
- Create a preset from selected keyframes with Add preset from Keys.
- Click a preset bar to focus the timeline to that saved range.
- Drag preset number boxes to move a preset without triggering focus.
- Drag preset edges to adjust its start or end frame.
- Double-click a preset name to rename it inline.
- Right-click a preset for rename, edit range, color, or delete actions.

Preset Panel

- The preset panel defaults to one visible row to save vertical space.
- Use the hide button to collapse or show the preset section.
- Resize the preset panel with the handle; it snaps to row-height increments.
- Use scrolling or panning to navigate when presets exceed the visible area.

Options

- Start with 3ds Max enables or disables the startup launcher.
- Randomize colors gives newly created preset bars randomized preset colors.

Scene Storage

- Preset data is stored inside the current Max file.
- Opening a Max file reloads that file's saved preset bars.

- New or reset empty scenes clear the preset list.
- Global UI preferences stay separate from scene preset data.

Support

GitHub: <https://github.com/TheTreeHouseof95/CRAFT---Timeline-Assist.git>

Bugs/requests: <https://github.com/TheTreeHouseof95/CRAFT---Timeline-Assist/discussions>

Email: thetreehouseof95@gmail.com

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